No sooner had Rajiv joined politics than Congress members and ministers all across the country queued up to salaam him. He was asked to lay foundation stones for medical colleges, open electric lines to Harijan colonies, give speeches to Congress clubs on Nehru's birthday. This build-up of the future leader was the subject of a satirical column by the Bombay writer 'Busybee' (Behram Contractor), a still unparalleled commentary on the culture of sycophancy in India's oldest political party. Here is the column, reproduced more or less in full:

> The Padayatra (Walking Tour) Programme
>
> Apropos Sunday morning's padayatra through the Dharavi slums by Mr Rajiv Gandhi, the following is the programme (Congress-I volunteers to note):
>
> 7.30 a.m.: Mr Rajiv Gandhi arrives at Santa Cruz Airport, received by 20,000 party workers (trucks will be provided to transport them …) Garlanding ceremony. Workers to shout: 'Rajiv Gandhi ki jai!'
>
> 8 a.m.: Motorcade leaves airport and proceeds to Dharavi passing under welcome arches along the route …
>
> 8.10 a.m.: Housewives of the government housing colony at East Bandra to spontaneously halt the motor cavalcade and perform the arti ceremony for Mr Gandhi. Local Congress (I) councillors to organize the housewives.
>
> 8.30 a.m.: Arrive at Dharavi … Welcome speech by Dharavi councillor and MLA. Garlanding ceremony. Flag-hoisting of Congress flag by children of the Dharavi municipal school.
>
> 9 a.m.: Tea and refreshments in school hall. Mr Gandhi receives telephone calls from … chief minister … and deputy chief minister, welcoming him to Bombay. A special telephone line to be installed … to enable Mr Gandhi to receive the calls.
>
> 9.30 a.m.: Mr Gandhi changes his chappals for gym shoes … Padayatra begins. (Organizers to note: Mr Gandhi should be taken only along those lanes which have been specially swept and cleaned for the padayatra.)
>
> 10 a.m.: TV cameras in position to take special shots of Mr Gandhi talking to oldest resident of Dharavi. TV shot of Mr Gandhi inaugurating new public tap. (Note to organizers: Arrangements should be made to fly colour film back to Delhi in time for inclusion in national news same night.)
>
> 10.30 a.m. to 11.30 a.m.: Mr Gandhi makes four speeches at four different locations in Dharavi, preferably where pressmen are present. (Further note to organizers: cars to be kept ready for Mr Gandhi to travel from one padayatra spot to another. Arrangements to be made for a man to hold umbrella over Mr Gandhi's head.)
>
> Noon: Padayatra ends. Mr Gandhi changes gym shoes for sandals.